MIND IT! — QUICK START

Your first quiz in 10 minutes (Mind It! v1.69)

This is the short version for a night **in the room** — team phones, a TV, maybe the Galaxy Tab. Hosting on a **video call** (Teams, Zoom or Meet)? Read *The Complete Idiot's Guide* (`MIND_IT_COMPLETE_IDIOTS_GUIDE.pdf`), the Online Mode edition. Keep the **Quizmaster Cheat Sheet** next to you on the night.

1. Get the app running (2 minutes)

1. **Windows laptop:** put the four `Mind It!.exe.part…` files and `Join Mind It - build 160.bat` in one folder. Double-click the **.bat**. When it says **Done**, double-click `Mind It!.exe`. (From the GitHub download page you get **one complete** `Mind It!.exe` — no joining.) - "Windows protected your PC"? → **More info → Run anyway**. - Windows asks about network access? → allow **Private networks** (phones and the tablet need it). - **Apple Silicon Mac instead?** Join the parts in Terminal (or use the single zip from GitHub) and drag `Mind It!.app` into Applications. First open: **Apple menu → System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway**; allow **local network** access. - **Updates:** ⬆ **Update App** on the main menu, or **Settings → 6 · Advanced → ⬆ App Update** (never during a game).
2. **Galaxy Tab (optional):** install `Mind It! for Android (Galaxy Tab).apk` (allow "install unknown apps"). It updates itself: ⬆ **Update App** on its home screen (tap to check, tap again to install), or **Settings → App Update → Check For Updates**. **The same app runs on an Android phone** too (upright only) — handy as a remote, or to host a small quiz with no laptop. **iPad or iPhone instead?** No install: on the laptop open 📲 **Connect ▾ → Connect Device** and scan the **iPad / iPhone** code with the Camera. The first time it asks for the PIN; after that it reconnects by itself. Only one remote controls the quiz — a second one waits until you tap **Allow & Switch** on the laptop. **No laptop?** The tablet (or phone) is then the server: team phones join it.
3. The laptop opens on its **main menu**: ▶ **Prepare tonight's quiz** (Enter), ⏯ **Continue last game** (only after an unfinished game), **Question Database**, **Players & History**, **Rehearsal** and **Settings** (Setup). **Ready to play** shows what's connected, with 📺 **Connect a TV** while no TV is, and the phones that have joined. With the Galaxy Tab linked, ⟳ **Sync devices** gives the laptop and the tablet the same players, Historic Games and questions (the tablet has its own ⟳ **Sync**, and syncs after every saved game). They also sync by themselves when the tablet connects: the laptop says ⟳ **Synced with …**.
4. Panels open on top of each other — Players & History → a player → a game: the ← button at the top names the screen it goes back to (**← Players & History**) and goes back one step, **Close** goes back to where you started (the main menu, Setup, or the tablet's home).

2. Make the quiz (3 minutes)

Press ▶ **Prepare tonight's quiz**:

- 🔁 **Same as last time → Use last game's setup** — last game's teams, players, rules, theme and special question; only the questions are new.
- 🎯 **New quiz, step by step → Start the steps** — **Questions → Teams → How you play → Check**.
- ⚡ **Quick game → Play now** — 4 teams, 2 rounds, random questions from your Question Database.

The steps:

1. **Questions:** 🎲 **Random from the Question Database**, or 📄 **Load an Excel quiz** (the Question Database's ⬇ **Excel ▾ → Quiz Template** gives a blank one: fill in the yellow cells). ✎ **Edit the questions** opens **Setup → 4 · Rounds & Questions** (tabs **Rounds · Questions · ⭐ Mastermind It!**). Values are automatic: Round 1 = 200–1,000, Round 2 = 400–

2,000. Sound clips (MP3, M4A, WAV) work like clue pictures: you get ▶ **Play /** ⟲ **Replay /** ■ **Stop**, and the clips are evened out in loudness.

2. **Teams:** 2 to **10** teams, at least **one player** each (**+ Player**), or 🎲 **Random teams**. A team with one player takes that player's name and picture. **The Quizmaster can't play** (2 · Teams & Players → 🎤 Quizmaster).
3. **How you play: In the room** (answers out loud, Full Show rules) · **Phone Buzzers** (needs the laptop or tablet app, phones on the same Wi-Fi) · **Online call** (a video call — see the Complete Idiot's Guide). Then the **Special Question**: 🕶️ **Blind It!** (teams bet) or 🤠 **Rewind It!** (a wheel: 1×–5×; no chips that game), **Speed Bonus** and **Phoenix Chip · Triple Gamble**.
4. **Check:** green ticks, or **Fix ›**, **Connect ›**, **Back up ›** buttons that jump to the problem. Then **Begin game** ▶.

Question Database shortcuts: after you add questions to a round once, ➕ **Add to Round N** adds the next ones in one tap (**Other round...** for another round). ⇄ on a question moves it to another round with one tap (full rounds are greyed out). 🔄 **Replace Round from Database** with a template round that has fewer categories empties the rest of the round — ↩ **Undo** brings the old round back. Each question shows how often it was got right (✓ **2 of 3 games**); **More ▾ →** 📊 **Question stats** lists the ones nobody got and the ones everybody got.

All the detailed settings are still in Setup (**Open all settings ›**). Lowering **Categories** or **Clues per category** asks first if questions would be removed. 💡 **Hint** has its own switch in **3 · Gameplay & Rules** (on by default).

3. Connect the screens (3 minutes)

1. **TV:** plug in HDMI (Windows key + P → *Extend*). Press **Open Audience View (TV)**, drag the window to the TV, press its **Full Screen** button. **No cable?** 📺 **Audience View ▾ →** 📡 **Connect Audience Screen**, type the address it shows (e.g. `192.168.1.20/tv`) into the TV's web browser, press ⛶ **Full Screen** on the TV, then 🧪 **Test Audience Screen**. Want the sound from the TV's speakers? 🔊 **Sound On This TV**, then press **OK** on the TV remote. Set the TV's volume with 🔊 **Sound Check** (**Setup → Presentation → Sound**): six sounds, one after another, each named as it plays.
2. **Mi Box / Android TV:** install **Mind It! TV** once and open it — it finds the quiz by itself. Not listed? It shows a **4-digit code**: on the laptop (or the tablet) 📺 **Connect Audience Screen →** 📺 **Add a TV**, type the code, **Send to the TV**. Mind It! TV also updates itself from the laptop.
3. **Tablet:** laptop **Connect ▾ → Connect Device**; tablet **Connect To Laptop → Connect** (the PIN only the first time). New tablet app? The tablet shows **Update Available → Update**. On the tablet's quiz page, **Back** needs a second press to leave (*Press Back again to leave the quiz*). 🛟 **It's also your backup host:** while a quiz runs the tablet keeps a copy (🛟 **Backup ready**). If the laptop stops, after about 10 seconds it offers 🛟 **Take over on this tablet** — one tap, same question, and phones and Mind It! TV follow.
4. **Phones:** before the game the TV shows the 🚪 **lobby**: your welcome message, a countdown to the start time, each team as its phone joins, and the **"Scan to join your team"** QR code (set the message and time in **Setup → Presentation → Audience View & Presentation**). Each team scans it and types its **4-letter team code** (see 🔐 **Team Codes**). iPhone tip: Safari **Share → Add to Home Screen** gives a full-screen **Mind It!** icon.
5. **Everyone on the same Wi-Fi.** Guest/hotel Wi-Fi blocking phones? Turn on the **laptop's mobile hotspot** and join everything to it. No internet needed.
6. Press 📶 **Check Connections → TEST ALL CONNECTIONS**. Aim for "All set".

Practise first: a rehearsal with bots

Main menu → Rehearsal plays a test game that never counts (no history, stats or achievements; **End Rehearsal** puts everything back). Under 🤖 **Bots** add up to three computer teams next to your real ones — **Sparky (Rookie)** gets about 1 in 3 right and is slow, **Byte (Pro)** about 6 in 10, **Quanta (Genius)** about 85 % and wagers to win.

- On its turn a bot **picks a clue** and says which one, then **says its answer out loud** (the laptop's own voice, at the game's volume; silent when the sound is off) and on the TV.
- **Marking → I mark them** (the default): the bot waits for you — the host bar says 👆 **Mark it: Correct or Wrong Answer**. **Bots mark themselves** marks them for you. A bot may also **pass**.

- Bots bet on their Blind It! and Mastermind It! questions and write a Mastermind It! answer (you mark it like the phones' answers). In Phone Buzzer Mode they buzz like a phone — the first buzz still wins.

4. Play! (the rest of the night)

The TV board shows each category name on a big plaque, on up to two lines. Your 🎨 **Theme** (**Setup → Presentation**) colours the TV and also your host screens and the Galaxy Tab remote. 🪔 **Diwali** has its own sounds with **Theme Sounds On** (a temple bell, firecrackers, a shehnai flourish for the winner) and says **"✦ Shubh Deepavali ✦"** on the opening title. After **Begin game**, press ▶ **Start the show** (Space): the intro, **Tonight's teams**, **How to play** (5 s) and Round 1's categories (3 s each) play on their own, then the board. ⏸ **Hold** (H) keeps a screen up; ⏭ **Next** moves on.

You want to…	Laptop	Tablet
Open a question	Click the value on the board preview (or **Pick a clue**)	Tap the value
They're right	**CORRECT** (C) — the team's name is on it; shows ⚡ +bonus while the speed bonus is on offer	✓ Correct
They're wrong (–points, next team tries)	**WRONG ANSWER** (W)	× Wrong Answer
They pass (free, next team tries)	**PASS** (S)	→ Pass
Pause / resume the clock	**Pause timer** (T)	⏸ Pause
More time	**+30 Sec**	+30 Sec
Show the answer	**Reveal answer** (R)	Reveal Answer
Oops!	**Undo last score** (U) — also gives back a chip	↶ Undo
Fix a score	Click the team's row in **Scores**	± Adjust Score
Team admin	**Teams ▾** → Make active · Mark away · Adjust score	More Controls
Finish the round now	**End round early** (**Shift+E**)	End Round Early
End the whole game now	**⋯ ▾ →** 🏁 **End game now** (asks first)	More Controls → 🏁 End Game Now
Reset the game	**⋯ ▾ → Reset game** (asks first)	—

Scoring in one breath: right = **+value**; wrong = **–value** (the question goes to the next team with a fresh 45 s); pass = **0** (next team gets 30 s + time left, max 45 s); **time runs out = an automatic pass** 2 s later (0, next team gets 30 s; Blind It!, Rewind It! and Triple Gamble questions stay with the team). ⏰ **Time's Up** in the Timer card (it was End Timer) counts as the clock running out. For those 2 s the question card (and the tablet) says *Time's up for X — passing to Y…*: a CORRECT / WRONG ANSWER then still scores X. Later, **Score X…** in the question card still can. If X was the last team, **Give X its answer back** shows while *No One Answered* closes. **Phone Buzzer Mode:** a team that buzzed keeps its turn when the time runs out (you give the verdict); if nobody buzzed, nothing is passed: choose **Reopen Buzzers** or **No One Answered**. Answering a passed question = **+25% per pass**. The picking team answering right within **10 s** = **+half the round's lowest value** (Round 1: +100). **Blind It! question:** bet from the value up to your score (or up to 1,000 if your score is lower). **Rewind It! question:** 🤠 **Spin The Wheel** (in Phone Buzzer Mode the team spins and stops it on its phone) → right = +value × 1–5, wrong = –value × the same (4× and 5× lose 3.5×). With 3+ question rounds the last one hides a 🎡 **Wild** square too. **Triple Gamble:** 3× (6× on a Blind It! question). **Phoenix:** the last team, if more than 2,000 behind from Round 2, can score double + 20% of the gap (capped at the leader; only a speed bonus can take it past); wrong costs nothing. **Bottoms Up (Round 1):** wrong costs nothing if the designated player finishes their drink.

💡 **The hint (since build 155):** each team may take **one hint per game** from **its own phone** — the team answering first (the buzz winner in Phone Buzzer Mode, otherwise the team whose turn it is; on Blind It!, the team that wagered), before any wrong answer or pass. Only that phone sees it: the answer's **first letter and length** (e.g. N___ A_____). The TV shows 💡 on the team and *"took their hint · pays half"*. **Right = half the value** (half the wager on Blind It!), **wrong = the full value** (the whole wager), **no speed bonus**. With 🔥 **Phoenix**, right = half the Phoenix amount and wrong still costs nothing. A team the question passes to doesn't get it. Not in Online Mode or a Rehearsal; a team with no phone has no hint. Your CORRECT button shows the half with a 💡.

😺 **The Rascala! badge:** during play the last-place team's TV score card wears the cowboy cat (nobody while all teams are level). Each phone shows its team's **place card** at the bottom: place, score and the gap to the team above.

Mastermind It!: teams with 0 or more points bet 0–their score on their phones, the question appears, they type one answer (typed answers close 2 s after time's up). Then the **step card** takes over: mark each team **✓ / ✕ / No loss**, then ▶ **Reveal all — lowest first** (about 2.5 s each; ⏸ **Pause**; or one at a time with V). Right = +bet, wrong = –bet. **Level on points for 1st?** ⚡ **Play Tiebreaker**, or the team with more correct answers wins.

5. The end of the night — one gold button per step

The **step card** at the top of your host panel (laptop and Galaxy Tab, upright or sideways) shows **Mark · Reveal · Standings · Awards · Winner · Rascala · End**. Press the gold ▶ **Next** button (or **Space**); ◀ **Back** is always there.

1. **Final standings:** 4th place and below; **the top three stay secret** (skipped with 3 teams or fewer).
2. **Tonight's awards:** one page of highlights, fun stats and achievements — nothing that gives away the top three.
3. **The podium:** 3rd, then 2nd, then **"And the winner is..."**. 🏆 **Champions Card** is here.
4. 😺 **The Rascala!:** then the last-place team, with the cowboy cat and its voice. It stays until you press the gold button.
5. From the podium on: 📊 **Night Recap**, 💾 **Save picture** and 🔁 **Rematch** (same teams and rules, new questions, through Prepare tonight's quiz's Check). Each team's **phone** gets its night as a picture (place, score, best moment) to save or share.
6. 🏁 **End Quiz & save** saves the game to **Historic Games** and **Player Profiles** (tap an achievement there to see what it means), says thanks, and goes back to the main menu (the tablet's home). A tablet or phone used as a **remote** keeps its own 🏁 **END GAME** button.
7. **⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Back Up Now** — keep a copy.

If something goes wrong

- **The app closed?** Reopen it → ⏯ **Continue last game** (or **Resume saved game**). Re-open the Audience View. Phones and the tablet reconnect by themselves.
- **The laptop stopped mid-quiz and won't come back?** On the Galaxy Tab (your remote): 🛟 **Take over on this tablet**, then **Resume Timer**. Phones and Mind It! TV follow; a TV on the laptop's HDMI needs the cable moved. The laptop never scores that quiz again.
- **A phone won't join?** Same Wi-Fi, mobile data off, scan the TV code again — or use the laptop's hotspot.
- **No 💡 on a team's phone?** Only the team answering first gets it, before any wrong answer or pass, once per game — and only with 💡 **Hint** on and the phone connected.
- **The laptop and the tablet show different games?** ⟳ **Sync devices** on the laptop's main menu, or ⟳ **Sync** on the tablet.
- **Restore a backup on the Galaxy Tab:** tablet home → **Settings → Backup →** ⬆ **Restore From Backup File** (a `.txt` or `.json` backup). It asks first and adds the players and games in the file; nothing is deleted.
- **Wrong score? Undo** (U) right away, or click the team's score to adjust it, with a reason.
- **Went into Setup mid-game?** The game is paused. When you go back, the clock carries on from where it was. **+ Add Team** stays locked until the game ends.

- **Setup changes not kept?** While the Resume offer shows, they aren't saved until you choose **Resume saved game** or **Start fresh**.
- **The tablet showed an error?** On the laptop: **Setup → 6 · Advanced → Diagnostics → Tablet Errors →** 📋 **Copy Error Details**, and send what it copies.
- **A take-over request says ⚠ Not a paired device?** Only allow it if it is your own Galaxy Tab.
- **The Phone Remote says a tap was ignored?** The screen had already changed. Check it and tap again.
- **TV says "Reconnecting to Host..."?** Make sure the laptop's host window is open; it clears by itself.
- **Mind It! TV can't find the quiz?** Same Wi-Fi; type its 4-digit code in 📺 **Add a TV**.
- **Started the quiz on the Galaxy Tab and the laptop arrives?** Open Mind It! on the laptop (same Wi-Fi) → 💻 **Take Over Tablet Quiz** → approve it on the tablet. **The laptop has to leave?** 📲 **Connect ▾ → Hand Quiz to the Galaxy Tab → Offer Quiz**, then **Host It on This Tablet** on the tablet.
- **Something went wrong in the rehearsal?** 📲 **Connect ▾ →** 📋 **Rehearsal Report → Save Report File**, and send the file.
- **Before the guests arrive:** 📲 Connect ▾ → Connect Device → 🧪 **Test Hosting → Run Test** should say *Ready to host*.

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